



INNOVATION

YOU CAN RELATE TO

JANANI GOPALAKRISHNAN VIKRAM



Livescribe smartpen instantly digitises handwritten stuff (Courtesy: Livescribe)

Livescribe: Smart pen-paper combo that saves notes digitally

Even in today's digital world, there are many who prefer a pen and paper to jot things down, whether it is a shopping list or the minutes of a meeting. The

Livescribe 3 smartpen ensures that these hurriedly noted down texts do not get lost. The Bluetooth Smart enabled pen digitises notes written on a special dotted paper and saves these in your mobile device with appropriate tags, using an associated app.

At first look, the smartpen appears to be a stylish, premium ballpoint pen with a Swiss-made tungsten-carbide ballpoint ink cartridge. Inside however is a whole lot of technology—from an infrared camera and ARM processor to a Bluetooth Smart chipset, flash memory and lithium-ion battery. An integrated stylus cap conceals the micro-USB port to charge the device.

The pen works with Livescribe + mobile app, which instantly syncs everything users write on paper to their mobile devices. The notes can be viewed in either Page View or Feed View, where they are sorted into smaller snippets. You can search, tag and convert them into text. The app also lets you add audio to the notes. Reminders, appointments and lists that you have jotted down by hand can be used to automatically set up calendar events and add new contacts. The content can also be converted into shareable PDF files. So that wonderful start-up idea, sketched on a paper napkin at a coffee shop, can be shared instantly with those who matter!

Company: Livescribe (part of the Anoto group AB); **Country:** United States of America; **Website:** <https://www.livescribe.com/en-gb/smartpen/l3/3/>

Neil, the Little Explorer: Your child's robot companion

Working parents are often unable to spend enough time with their kids, and as a result they are unaware of their children's real interests. In a simple but effective way, **Neil, the Little Explorer**, can help such parents.

Neil is a robotic toy that keeps your child company all day long. An associated mobile app lets parents watch what their kids learn, and understand patterns about their likes and dislikes. They get to know their child's curiosity towards a particular subject like new places, planets or biology. These patterns also help Neil to share apt information related to the child's interests, so the interactions are more engaging.



Neil, the Little Explorer, chats with your kids and shares facts/notes on various subjects

Press a button at any time and it will share a factoid (wiki as they call it) in a very conversational way. Simple button controls let Neil know if the child loved it or wants to move to the next one, revisit the previous one or get a wiki related to the current location. While the conversation is in English by default, you can buy additional language packages if you wish.

Created by the Another Circus Design Agency, Neil levitates a bit once in a while to remind the child of its presence. It has a pleasant LED light that lights up the child's room at night. Charging is as simple as placing Neil on its 'planet' or base station.

Company: Another Circus Design Agency; **Country:** Greece; **Website:** <http://www.neilthelittleexplorer.com/>, <https://www.anothercircus.com/>

ili: Wearable, instant translator

Not being understood in a foreign land can be both fun and dangerous, whichever way you see it! The problem only gets worse when you travel to places where the locals do not understand English, and you are also unable to connect to the Internet to use an online translator.

ili is a wearable translator that can solve this problem for you. A compact device with an in-built processor and memory, it can translate conversations instantly without requiring an Internet connection. It translates using an in-device database, and can do its job in just 0.2 seconds! ili's dynamic dual microphone enables noise cancellation, and smart amplifiers and speaker ensure clear sound output. The sound is captured clearly, translated and instantly output in the other language.



ili is a wearable translator that lets you communicate in English, Japanese and Chinese instantly without Internet or Wi-Fi connection (Courtesy: Logbar)

Likewise, replies are also translated, so the conversation is completely understandable to both parties. Currently, ili works in English, Japanese and Chinese but there are plans to include more languages, too.

What makes ili so innovative is that it is a standalone device that does not require a mobile app, Internet or Wi-Fi. It is truly a hassle-free and easy-to-use translator!

Company: Logbar; **Country:** Japan; **Website:** <http://logbar.jp/en/index.html>, <http://iamili.com/>